

True BASIC

The biggest irritant in the BASIC programming language was the adding of line numbers before every line. If you needed to insert more commands after your program was written, you would have to sometimes change all the line numbers. The first BASIC variant to dispense with line numbers, True BASIC was launched in 1983 and appeared on the market in 1985. The main advantages were that it allowed a graphical backdrop to the program, which made it easier for programmers to distinguish between coding elements. It also allowed a rudimentary form of copy-paste called “blitting.”

Microsoft Windows 1.0.1 was later to be released in 1985. This was the very first OS from Microsoft to provide a graphical interface, although it was only a front-end to the then-dominant MS-DOS Windows 1.0; it offered limited multitasking capabilities and a graphical interface for DOS programs that were compiled to run on Windows 1.0.

It was for the first time ever that users were able to run two applications simultaneously in a graphical user interface. Multiple windows on the screen were tiled and could not overlap each other. However, dialog boxes and menus could overlap the window. The earliest test builds of Windows 1.0 had pull-up menus that appeared at the bottom of the screen like in DOS, this was changed to be at the top of the screen when the software was finally released. It required MS-DOS to run in the background since Windows 1.0 ran a program called MS-DOS Executive on start up to bring up the GUI interface. Without first installing MS-DOS, therefore, you could not run Windows!



The splash screen of the First Ever Windows!